

ABC Company

Frequently Asked Questions & Standard Responses

Document ID	ABC-DOC-009
Version	v1.0
Date	June 2026
Prepared By	ABC Company — Business Development
Classification	Business Confidential

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Table of Contents

- 1. General Questions
- 2. Services Questions
- 3. Pricing Questions
- 4. Process Questions
- 5. Technical Questions
- 6. Post-Launch & Support Questions
- 7. Objection Handling

About This Document

This document contains the official pre-approved FAQ responses for ABC Company. It is intended for use by the AI-powered email response agent, business development staff, and account managers when responding to inbound inquiries. All answers have been reviewed and approved by the Business Development and Legal teams.

The document is organized into seven categories covering general company information, services, pricing, process, technical practices, post-launch support, and objection handling. Each answer is a complete, standalone response that can be used as-is or lightly adapted to the specific context of an inquiry. Agents should use the most relevant answer as a foundation, personalizing the opening and closing lines while preserving the substantive content.

This document is classified as Business Confidential. The specific rates, SLA commitments, and discount structures contained herein reflect our current standard terms and should not be cited in legally binding correspondence without review by the Business Development lead. When in doubt, direct the prospect to schedule a discovery call by emailing hello@abccompany.io.

1. General Questions

The following questions address the most common introductory inquiries about ABC Company — who we are, where we operate, and what sets us apart. These answers provide the foundational context that prospects typically need before discussing specific project requirements.

What does ABC Company do?

ABC Company is a full-service technology agency that designs, builds, and maintains custom software solutions for businesses across the globe. Founded in 2015 and headquartered in Colombo, Sri Lanka, with offices in London and Melbourne, we have a team of 60 professionals specializing in web development, mobile applications, cloud infrastructure, AI/ML, UI/UX design, quality assurance, and technical consulting. Over the past nine years, we have delivered more than 150 projects for over 40 active clients across industries including fintech, healthcare, e-commerce, SaaS, logistics, and education technology.

Where are you located?

Our headquarters is in Colombo, Sri Lanka, where our primary development center operates with 45 team members. We also have offices in London, United Kingdom, which serves as our European business development hub with 10 team members, and Melbourne, Australia, which handles our Asia-Pacific operations with 5 team members. This global presence enables us to provide timezone coverage across CET, EST, PST, and AEST, allowing us to serve clients effectively regardless of their geographic location.

How large is your team?

We currently have 60 full-time professionals across eight disciplines: 15 frontend engineers, 18 backend engineers, 8 mobile developers, 6 DevOps engineers, 5 AI/ML engineers, 8 QA specialists, 6 designers, and 4 project managers. Our seniority distribution is 20% junior, 45% mid-level, 25% senior, and 10% lead or principal level. Our team holds over 30 professional certifications, including 12 AWS Solutions Architect certifications, and maintains an average tenure of 3.4 years, well above the industry average.

How long have you been in business?

ABC Company was founded in 2015, giving us over nine years of operational experience in software development and consulting. In that time, we have grown from a team of 4 engineers focused on local web development to a 60-person global technology agency delivering complex, enterprise-grade solutions. We have completed over 150 projects, weathered the challenges of rapid growth, and established ourselves as a recognized technology partner with ISO 27001 certification, AWS Advanced Partner status, and Clutch Top B2B Company recognition.

What industries do you specialize in?

We serve eight primary industry verticals: Financial Technology (payment platforms, banking apps, regulatory compliance), Healthcare (patient portals, telemedicine, HIPAA-compliant systems), E-Commerce (marketplace platforms, inventory management, payment integrations), SaaS (analytics platforms, multi-tenant applications), Logistics (fleet management, route optimization, real-time tracking), Education Technology (learning management systems, AI-powered tutoring), Property Technology (property management, tenant portals), and Media & Entertainment (content management, streaming platforms). Our cross-industry experience allows us to bring best practices from one domain to another.

Do you work with startups or only enterprise clients?

We work with organizations of all sizes, from pre-seed startups building their first MVP to enterprise companies with complex integration needs. Approximately 40% of our projects are for startups and early-stage companies (typically our Starter and Growth package tiers), 35% are for mid-market scaleups, and 25% are for enterprise organizations. Our engagement models are designed to be flexible — startups benefit from our fixed-price MVP packages and lean team compositions, while enterprises leverage our dedicated team model and comprehensive project management frameworks.

What certifications does ABC Company hold?

ABC Company holds ISO 27001 certification for Information Security Management, ensuring that our data handling and security practices meet international standards. We are an AWS Advanced Consulting Partner with 12 certified Solutions Architects, a Google Cloud Partner with 3 certified engineers, and have been recognized as a Clutch Top B2B Company. Additionally, our team holds individual certifications including CKA/CKAD (Kubernetes), CSM (Scrum Master), Terraform Associate, and various database certifications. These certifications are not just badges — they represent our commitment to staying current with industry best practices and platform capabilities.

Can we visit your office?

Absolutely. We welcome client visits to any of our three offices. Our Colombo headquarters features a modern open-plan workspace where you can meet the development team, attend sprint demos in person, and get a firsthand view of our working culture. Our London and Melbourne offices are smaller but equally equipped for client meetings. For clients who prefer remote interaction, we offer virtual office tours and are fully set up for distributed collaboration with high-quality video conferencing, screen sharing, and real-time collaboration tools.

What makes ABC Company different from other agencies?

Six key differentiators set us apart. First, our fast ramp-up capability — we can onboard 2-3 engineers within two weeks. Second, transparent pricing with no hidden costs and detailed estimation methodology shared upfront. Third, dedicated teams with named team members (not a rotating pool), with an average tenure of 3.4 years ensuring project continuity. Fourth, full IP ownership — all work is work-for-hire and the client owns 100% from day one. Fifth, timezone flexibility with CET primary coverage and EST, PST, and AEST overlap. Sixth, end-to-end delivery covering everything from strategy and design through development, testing, and ongoing maintenance.

2. Services Questions

These questions cover the specific services, technologies, and capabilities that ABC Company offers. Answers here are designed to help prospects understand the breadth of what we can deliver and whether our technical stack aligns with their project needs.

What technologies do you work with?

Our technology stack spans the full spectrum of modern software development. On the frontend, we primarily use React and Next.js, with expertise in Angular, Vue.js, and Svelte. For mobile, React Native with Expo is our default cross-platform framework, complemented by Flutter, Swift, and Kotlin for native development. Our backend teams work with Node.js/NestJS and Python/FastAPI as primary frameworks, with Go and .NET for specialized use cases. We use PostgreSQL as our default database, with MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, and DynamoDB for specific needs. For cloud infrastructure, AWS is our primary platform (12 certified architects), with Azure and GCP capabilities. Our AI/ML stack includes OpenAI, LangChain, TensorFlow, and PyTorch.

Do you build mobile apps?

Yes, mobile app development is one of our core services. We have 8 dedicated mobile developers with expertise in React Native (our primary cross-platform framework), Flutter, Swift (iOS), and Kotlin (Android). For most projects, we recommend React Native with Expo for its code-sharing benefits with web applications, faster development cycles, and excellent native performance. For projects requiring deep platform integration (such as HealthKit, ARKit, or Android's camera APIs), we recommend native development. We handle the complete mobile lifecycle including UI/UX design optimized for mobile, development, app store submission (both Apple App Store and Google Play), and post-launch support including OTA updates.

Can you help with AI and machine learning?

Absolutely. Our AI/ML practice has 5 dedicated engineers specializing in three areas: LLM-powered applications (chatbots, AI agents, RAG systems using OpenAI GPT-4o and Anthropic Claude with frameworks like LangChain), traditional machine learning (recommendation engines, predictive analytics, anomaly detection using TensorFlow, PyTorch, and scikit-learn), and data engineering (data pipelines with Apache Airflow, transformations with dbt, warehousing with Snowflake). Recent projects include building a RAG-powered customer support agent, an AI-driven adaptive learning platform, and real-time fraud detection for a fintech client.

Do you offer UI/UX design services?

Yes, we have a dedicated design team of 6 designers covering the full spectrum of UI/UX work. Our design process follows a design thinking methodology: we start with user research and persona development, move through wireframing and information architecture, create high-fidelity visual designs in Figma, build interactive prototypes for user testing, and develop comprehensive design systems with reusable component libraries. We believe design is not just about making things look good — it's about solving user problems effectively. All our designers are proficient in accessibility standards (WCAG 2.1 AA) and mobile-first responsive design principles.

Can you work with our existing codebase?

Yes, we regularly take over and improve existing codebases. Our process begins with a thorough code audit and architecture assessment where we evaluate code quality, test coverage, security vulnerabilities, dependency health, and scalability concerns. We produce a detailed technical debt report with prioritized recommendations. From there, we can gradually modernize the codebase while maintaining business continuity — we never propose a 'rewrite everything from scratch' approach unless it is genuinely the most cost-effective path. We have experience working with legacy systems in Java, PHP, Ruby, .NET, and older JavaScript frameworks, migrating them to modern stacks incrementally.

Do you provide ongoing support after launch?

Yes, we offer three tiers of ongoing support. Our Basic tier (20 hours/month, \$3,000-5,000) provides business-hours support with 48-hour response SLA, ideal for stable applications needing occasional maintenance. Our Standard tier (40 hours/month, \$6,000-10,000) adds extended-hours support, 24-hour response SLA, and monthly health reports. Our Premium tier (80+ hours/month, \$12,000-20,000) provides 24/7 support with 4-hour response SLA, a dedicated team, and proactive monitoring. All tiers include bug fixes, security patches, dependency updates, and minor feature enhancements. Major new features and redesigns are scoped and quoted separately.

Can you handle cloud infrastructure and DevOps?

Cloud infrastructure and DevOps is one of our strongest capabilities, with 6 dedicated DevOps engineers (50% senior+) and 12 AWS Solutions Architect certifications across the team. We handle cloud architecture design, migration from on-premises or other providers, CI/CD pipeline setup (GitHub Actions, GitLab CI), containerization (Docker + Kubernetes), infrastructure as code (Terraform), monitoring and alerting (Datadog, Grafana), and cost optimization. Every project we deliver includes a properly configured CI/CD pipeline and infrastructure documentation from day one — DevOps is not an afterthought but a core part of our development process.

Do you offer staff augmentation?

Yes, our staff augmentation service allows you to embed our engineers directly into your existing team. We offer three models: Individual Contributor (1-2 engineers), Pod (3-5 engineers with a team lead), or Full Team (6+ people including PM, QA, and DevOps). Engineers integrate into your tools, processes, and culture — they attend your standups, use your project management tools, and follow your coding standards. Minimum engagement is 3 months, with 2-week notice for scaling up or down. Our engineers are typically productive within the first week, thanks to our structured onboarding process.

What about security testing?

Security is embedded throughout our development process, not treated as a separate phase. We follow the OWASP Top 10 as our baseline security framework. All code undergoes automated security scanning through our CI/CD pipeline using tools like Snyk for dependency vulnerabilities and OWASP ZAP for dynamic application security testing. For applications handling sensitive data (fintech, healthcare), we conduct manual penetration testing either with our internal QA security specialists or through our partnership with external security firms. We can also support compliance certifications including HIPAA, PCI-DSS, SOC 2, and GDPR, though third-party audit fees are billed separately.

3. Pricing Questions

Pricing transparency is a core ABC Company value. The following answers provide honest, detailed information about our rates, package tiers, payment terms, and estimation methodology, helping prospects make informed budget decisions without needing a sales call first.

How much does a typical project cost?

Project costs vary significantly based on scope, complexity, and timeline, but we offer three package tiers as a starting framework. Our Starter package (\$15,000-\$45,000) covers MVPs and simple applications over 1-3 months. Our Growth package (\$50,000-\$180,000) covers full products and multi-feature platforms over 3-6 months. Our Enterprise package (\$200,000-\$500,000+) handles complex platforms, regulated industries, and large-scale systems over 6-12+ months. To give specific examples: a custom landing page typically costs \$8,000-15,000, a mobile app MVP runs \$25,000-50,000, a full SaaS platform ranges from \$100,000-250,000, and an AI chatbot integration is \$15,000-35,000. We always provide detailed estimates after understanding your specific requirements.

What are your hourly rates?

Our hourly rates range from \$35 to \$200 depending on the role and seniority level. Junior engineers are \$35-50/hour, mid-level engineers \$50-75/hour, senior engineers \$75-110/hour, and tech leads or architects \$110-150/hour. Specialized roles include ML/AI engineers at \$90-140/hour, DevOps engineers at \$70-110/hour, designers at \$55-85/hour, project managers at \$60-90/hour, QA engineers at \$40-65/hour, and CTO advisory at \$150-200/hour. Most project teams have a mix of seniority levels, resulting in blended rates of \$65-90/hour, which is 30-40% below comparable US and UK agency rates.

Do you offer fixed-price projects?

Yes, fixed-price is one of our standard engagement models and works well for projects with clearly defined scope and requirements. Under fixed-price, we provide a detailed Statement of Work with a firm price that does not change regardless of how long the project takes us to complete — ABC bears the estimation risk. Payment is structured as 30% on signing, 40% at a midpoint milestone, and 30% on delivery. If scope changes are needed during the project, we handle them through a formal Change Request process with transparent impact assessment. Fixed-price works best for MVPs, well-defined feature modules, and compliance-driven projects with stable requirements.

Is there a minimum project size?

Our minimum engagement is approximately \$8,000 for small, well-defined projects such as a custom landing page or a single-feature API. For Time & Materials engagements, we require a minimum commitment of 1 month. For dedicated teams, the minimum is 3 months. We find that projects below \$15,000 often don't justify the overhead of project setup, CI/CD configuration, and knowledge transfer, so for smaller needs we may recommend our consulting service (\$150-200/hour) for focused advisory sessions rather than a full development engagement.

Do you offer discounts?

Yes, we offer several discount programs. Long-term commitment of 6+ months qualifies for 5% off, and 12+ months qualifies for 10% off. Teams of 5 or more members get 5% off. Returning clients receive 5% off their next engagement. Non-profit and social impact organizations qualify for 15% off. Discounts can be combined up to a maximum of 25%. All discounts apply to our base rates and do not cover third-party costs such as cloud hosting, SaaS subscriptions, or certification audit fees.

How do you estimate project costs?

Our estimation process is rigorous and transparent. After the discovery phase, we break the project into user stories and estimate each using story points on a Fibonacci scale. We then convert story points to hours using our historical velocity data from similar projects. We add a 15-20% buffer for unknowns and edge cases that inevitably emerge during development. The resulting estimate includes detailed line items showing: features by priority, estimated hours per role, rate per role, subtotal per feature, and a project total with the buffer clearly marked. For Time & Materials projects, if the buffer isn't used, it isn't billed.

What are your payment terms?

For fixed-price projects, payment follows a 30/40/30 milestone structure: 30% on contract signing, 40% at a midpoint milestone, and 30% on delivery and acceptance. For Time & Materials and dedicated team engagements, we invoice monthly based on actual work, with Net-15 payment terms (payment due within 15 business days of invoice). We accept wire transfer, ACH, and major credit cards. Late payments incur a 1.5% monthly fee. For enterprise clients, we can accommodate custom billing arrangements including quarterly invoicing and purchase order-based payments.

Can you provide a rough estimate before a full discovery?

Absolutely. After an initial 30-60 minute call to understand your requirements, we can typically provide a rough order-of-magnitude estimate within 24-48 hours. This ballpark figure will have a +/-30% accuracy range and gives you enough information for internal budget discussions. For a more precise estimate (+/-10% accuracy), we recommend our paid discovery phase (typically 1-3 weeks, \$5,000-15,000), which produces a detailed requirements document, architecture proposal, and itemized cost estimate that serves as the foundation for the project proposal.

Are there any hidden costs?

No. Transparency is one of our core values and a key differentiator. Our estimates include all ABC Company labor costs — development, project management, QA, DevOps, and design. Items that are billed separately (and always disclosed upfront) include: third-party SaaS licenses and hosting costs (AWS, Stripe, etc.), app store developer accounts (\$99/year Apple, \$25 one-time Google), premium fonts or stock assets, travel expenses if on-site visits are required, and rush/overtime work which is billed at 1.5x standard rates. We never invoice for items not discussed and agreed upon in advance.

4. Process Questions

These questions address how ABC Company works — our development methodology, communication rhythms, contractual protections, and how we handle the inevitable challenges that arise during any software project.

What is your development process?

We follow Agile/Scrum methodology with 2-week sprints. Our process has six phases: Discovery (1-3 weeks) for requirements and planning, Design (2-4 weeks) for UX/UI and architecture, Development (variable) for iterative feature building with bi-weekly demos, Testing (2-4 weeks, overlapping with development) for QA and UAT, Launch (1-2 weeks) for deployment and go-live, and ongoing Support. Throughout development, you'll have access to a staging environment, weekly progress reports, and bi-weekly sprint demos. We use Jira or Linear for project management, Slack for daily communication, and GitHub for version control and CI/CD.

How do you communicate during a project?

Communication is structured around five channels: Slack for daily async communication (you get a dedicated channel), daily standups (15 min, async option available), bi-weekly sprint demos where we show completed work, weekly written progress reports from your PM, and monthly steering committee meetings for strategic alignment. Your project manager is your single point of contact and is available during business hours (CET, with EST/PST overlap as needed). We record all demos and important meetings for stakeholders who cannot attend live.

Do you sign NDAs?

Yes, we require a mutual NDA before sharing any confidential information in either direction. Our standard NDA covers a 12-month confidentiality period post-engagement and protects all project artifacts, business data, technical details, and strategic information. We can use our standard NDA template or review and sign yours — whichever your legal team prefers. For healthcare projects requiring HIPAA compliance, we also execute a Business Associate Agreement (BAA). For EU clients or projects involving EU citizen data, we provide a Data Processing Agreement (DPA) compliant with GDPR.

Who owns the code you write?

You do — 100%. All work performed by ABC Company is work-for-hire, meaning complete intellectual property ownership transfers to you from the moment the code is written. This includes all source code, designs, documentation, test suites, CI/CD configurations, and any other deliverables produced during the engagement. We retain no rights to use, modify, or redistribute your code. The only exception is pre-existing tools and libraries that ABC may use during development (such as internal utility libraries) — these remain ABC's property but are licensed to you for unlimited use within your project, and they are disclosed upfront before the engagement begins.

How quickly can you start a project?

For most engagements, we can begin within 2 weeks of contract signing. If we have engineers on the bench, we can start within 1 week. The first week is typically spent on onboarding and Sprint 0 (environment setup, CI/CD pipeline, architecture setup), with actual feature development beginning in week 2. For urgent projects requiring immediate start, we have a vetted contractor network that can be mobilized within days, though this may affect team composition. We recommend planning at least 2-3 weeks between contract signing and the desired start date to ensure optimal team assignment.

How do you handle scope changes?

Scope changes are a natural part of software development, and our process handles them transparently. For fixed-price projects, changes go through a formal Change Request (CR) process: the client submits the change, we assess the impact on timeline and budget within 48 hours, and the client decides whether to proceed, defer to a future phase, or withdraw the request. Approved CRs result in a revised SOW addendum. For T&M and dedicated team engagements, scope changes are handled more fluidly — we simply re-prioritize the backlog in the next sprint planning session. In both cases, we actively advise on trade-offs (e.g., 'this feature would add 3 weeks, but if we defer feature Y, the net impact is only 1 week').

How do we track project progress?

You have full visibility into project progress through multiple channels. Real-time access to our project management board (Jira or Linear) where you can see every user story's status, assignment, and progress. Your PM sends a weekly written report covering: work completed this week, planned for next week, risks and blockers, budget burn rate (T&M), and overall project health score (green/amber/red). Bi-weekly sprint demos let you see working software and provide feedback. Additionally, you have 24/7 access to the staging environment to test features as they're completed.

What happens if a team member leaves during my project?

We contractually guarantee team continuity. If a team member leaves ABC or needs to be reassigned, we provide a replacement of equal or greater seniority within 2 weeks at no additional cost. Our average team tenure of 3.4 years means mid-project departures are uncommon (fewer than 5% of engagements experience a team change). When a transition does occur, the departing team member participates in a structured knowledge transfer with their replacement, and we overlap both engineers for at least 1 week to ensure continuity. Your PM keeps you informed throughout the process.

5. Technical Questions

Technically-minded prospects and engineering leaders often want to understand our quality standards, tooling, and engineering practices before committing to an engagement. These answers provide the depth they need.

How do you ensure code quality?

Code quality is enforced through five layers. First, automated linting and formatting (ESLint + Prettier for JavaScript, Black + Ruff for Python) enforced by pre-commit hooks — no code can be committed without passing these checks. Second, mandatory code reviews on every pull request with at least one reviewer (two for critical paths like authentication and payments). Third, automated testing with a minimum 80% code coverage target, including unit, integration, and E2E tests. Fourth, CI/CD pipeline checks that must pass before any code is merged — this includes lint, type check, tests, and security scans. Fifth, regular architecture reviews where senior engineers assess the codebase for technical debt, performance issues, and security concerns.

How do you handle testing?

Our testing approach follows the test pyramid model: approximately 60% unit tests, 25% integration tests, and 15% end-to-end tests. We target a minimum of 80% code coverage across all projects. Unit and integration tests run on every commit via CI. E2E tests (using Playwright as our primary framework) run nightly and before every production release. Our QA team also performs manual exploratory testing, cross-browser testing across Chrome, Firefox, Safari, and Edge, and cross-device testing for mobile applications. For performance-critical applications, we conduct load testing with k6, simulating expected traffic patterns and stress scenarios. Security testing with OWASP ZAP is integrated into our CI pipeline for automated vulnerability scanning.

How do you handle security?

Security is embedded in every phase of our development process, not treated as a bolt-on. During design, we define the authentication and authorization model, data encryption strategy, and compliance requirements. During development, we follow OWASP Top 10 guidelines, use parameterized queries to prevent SQL injection, validate all user input, and manage secrets through environment variables and vault services — never hardcoded in source code. Our CI pipeline includes automated security scans with Snyk (dependency vulnerabilities) and OWASP ZAP (DAST). For sensitive applications (fintech, healthcare), we arrange external penetration testing. We hold ISO 27001 certification and can support HIPAA BAA, PCI-DSS compliance, and GDPR DPA requirements.

What happens if there's a bug after launch?

Every engagement includes a 30-day post-launch warranty at no additional cost. During this period, any bugs discovered in the delivered functionality are fixed according to severity-based SLAs: Critical bugs (system down or data loss risk) within 4 hours, High severity within 24 hours, Medium within 48 hours, and Low within 5 business days. After the warranty period, bug fixes are covered under your ongoing support tier (Basic, Standard, or Premium). If you don't have a support contract, we can address bugs on a T&M basis at standard hourly rates. We also recommend our maintenance packages which include proactive monitoring that catches many issues before your users notice them.

Can you work with our existing tech stack?

Yes, we are experienced in integrating with and extending existing technology stacks. While we have our preferred technologies (React, Node.js/NestJS, Python/FastAPI, PostgreSQL, AWS), we regularly work with client-mandated stacks including Java/Spring Boot, PHP/Laravel, Ruby on Rails, .NET/C#, Angular, Vue.js, and various database and cloud platforms. During the discovery phase, we assess your existing stack and recommend whether to extend it, gradually modernize it, or maintain compatibility while building new components alongside it. Our goal is always to enhance your existing investment, not force a wholesale technology change.

How do you handle data privacy and GDPR?

We take data privacy extremely seriously, particularly for clients handling EU citizen data. All ABC Company operations are governed by our ISO 27001-certified Information Security Management System. For GDPR compliance specifically, we implement data minimization principles, implement right-to-erasure and data portability features, ensure all personal data is encrypted at rest and in transit, maintain audit logs of data access, implement consent management mechanisms, and ensure data processing agreements (DPAs) are in place. We can also execute HIPAA Business Associate Agreements for healthcare clients and support PCI-DSS compliance for financial applications.

Do you use version control?

Yes, version control is fundamental to our workflow. We use Git with GitHub or GitLab (client's preference) for all projects. Our branching strategy follows either GitFlow or trunk-based development depending on team size and release cadence. All code changes go through pull requests with mandatory code reviews, automated CI checks, and approval requirements before merging. We maintain clear commit messages, tagged releases, and changelog documentation. The complete repository — including all branches, CI/CD configurations, and documentation — is handed over to the client at project completion.

6. Post-Launch & Support Questions

A successful launch is the beginning, not the end, of a software product's life. These answers explain how ABC Company supports clients after delivery — through structured support tiers, scaling assistance, and clean offboarding when clients are ready to bring development in-house.

What support options are available after launch?

We offer three tiers of ongoing support. Basic (\$3,000-5,000/month, 20 hours) provides business-hours support with 48-hour response SLA — ideal for stable applications. Standard (\$6,000-10,000/month, 40 hours) adds extended-hours support, 24-hour response SLA, and monthly health reports. Premium (\$12,000-20,000/month, 80+ hours) provides 24/7 support with 4-hour response SLA, a dedicated team, and proactive monitoring. All tiers include bug fixes, security patches, dependency updates, performance monitoring, and minor feature enhancements. Major new features are scoped and quoted separately.

Can you scale my application after launch?

Yes, application scaling is a core competency. Our approach depends on the scaling challenge. For traffic scaling, we implement auto-scaling groups, load balancers, CDN caching, and database read replicas. For feature scaling, we use microservices architecture to allow independent scaling of different application components. For team scaling, we can add 2-3 engineers within 2 weeks using our bench and contractor network. We also perform quarterly architecture reviews for our Premium support clients, proactively identifying scaling bottlenecks before they impact users.

What if we want to bring development in-house later?

We fully support and plan for client teams taking over development. Our offboarding process is a structured 4-week transition: Week 1 is a documentation audit ensuring all architecture docs, runbooks, and README files are complete. Week 2 features recorded knowledge transfer sessions covering system architecture, deployment, and operations. Week 3 is a gradual handover where your team takes primary ownership while we remain available for support. Week 4 is the final handover with credential transfer and completion checklist. After handover, we provide a 30-day free support window for questions. All source code, documentation, CI/CD configs, and operational runbooks are delivered in full.

How do you handle emergency issues?

For Premium support clients, we provide 24/7 emergency response with a 4-hour SLA. Emergency issues are triaged through a dedicated PagerDuty rotation and escalated to senior engineers immediately. For Standard clients, emergencies during extended business hours follow the 24-hour SLA. For clients without a support contract, we offer an emergency retainer option (\$2,000/month) that guarantees 8-hour response for critical issues. In all cases, we follow a structured incident response process: triage, contain, fix, deploy, post-mortem. All critical incidents receive a written post-mortem within 48 hours identifying root cause and preventive measures.

Do you provide monthly reports?

Standard and Premium support clients receive comprehensive monthly health reports covering: system uptime and availability metrics, performance trends (response times, error rates), security scan results (dependency vulnerabilities, DAST findings), resource utilization (CPU, memory, storage), support ticket summary (opened, resolved, outstanding), and recommendations for optimization. These reports are delivered by the 5th business day of each month and include a brief written analysis highlighting any areas requiring attention and proposed action items.

Can we pause and resume our engagement?

For dedicated team engagements, we require 30 days' notice for any team changes including pauses. If you need to pause for more than 2 months, we cannot guarantee the same team members will be available when you resume, as they may be assigned to other projects. For T&M engagements, you can pause at the end of any billing period with 2 weeks' notice. For fixed-price projects, pauses are discouraged as they disrupt momentum and may affect the team's context, but if necessary, we can agree on a pause-and-resume schedule with updated milestones. We do not charge during paused periods, but there may be a re-onboarding cost (typically 1-2 days) when resuming.

7. Objection Handling

The following responses address the most common objections and concerns that prospects raise during the sales process. These pre-approved answers are designed to be honest, non-defensive, and grounded in concrete evidence — not marketing language.

You seem expensive compared to other offshore agencies.

We understand that our rates are higher than some offshore providers, and we believe they represent fair value for the quality delivered. Our rates are 30-40% below comparable US and UK agencies, but 20-30% above the lowest-cost offshore options. The difference buys you: senior engineers (not junior developers learning on your project), mandatory code reviews and 80%+ test coverage (not 'it works on my machine' quality), proactive DevOps and security practices, a project manager as your single point of contact, and a 30-day warranty on all delivered work. Clients who have previously worked with lower-cost providers often tell us they spent more in the long run due to rework, bugs, and missed deadlines.

We had a bad experience with an outsourcing company before.

We hear this often, and we've built our processes specifically to avoid the common pitfalls of offshore development. First, you get named team members — not a rotating pool of anonymous developers. Second, full transparency: real-time access to our project board, weekly reports, and bi-weekly demos of working software. Third, quality enforcement: mandatory code reviews, automated testing, and CI/CD from day one. Fourth, communication: daily Slack availability, your PM responds within 2 hours during business hours. Fifth, accountability: we offer a 30-day warranty and contractual team continuity guarantees. We're happy to provide references from long-term clients who can speak to their experience working with us.

Can you guarantee a fixed deadline?

For fixed-price projects, yes — we commit to a timeline in the SOW and we absorb the risk if estimation was off. If we're running behind, we add resources at our cost. The caveat is that timeline guarantees only apply to the agreed scope. If scope changes are introduced (through the Change Request process), the timeline is adjusted accordingly with full transparency. For T&M and dedicated team engagements, we provide timeline estimates with confidence levels (e.g., '80% confidence we'll deliver the MVP in 12 weeks') and update these forecasts weekly based on actual velocity. We never promise dates we can't reasonably meet — overpromising and underdelivering is worse than honest estimation.

Can you guarantee prices won't change?

For fixed-price projects, the price is guaranteed for the agreed scope — it does not change regardless of how long the work takes. For T&M and dedicated team engagements, rates are locked for the contract duration (minimum 3 months for dedicated teams). Rate reviews may occur at annual renewal, and we provide 60 days' notice of any rate changes with justification. We also offer long-term commitment discounts: 5% for 6+ months and 10% for 12+ months, effectively locking in favorable rates. Third-party costs (AWS, SaaS subscriptions) are passed through at cost and may vary based on usage.

Why should we choose an agency instead of hiring in-house?

Hiring in-house is the right choice for long-term, core-competency work. An agency like ABC Company is ideal when: you need to move fast (we can start in 2 weeks vs. 2-3 months for hiring), you need specialized skills temporarily (e.g., an ML engineer for a 3-month AI feature), you want to validate an idea before committing to a full-time team, or you need to scale up and down flexibly without the overhead of employment. Many of our clients use a hybrid model — a core in-house team for ongoing product work, supplemented by ABC engineers for specific initiatives, surge capacity, or specialized expertise. We also support transitions: several clients have started with our dedicated team model and gradually built an in-house team, with us handling the knowledge transfer.

What if we're not satisfied with the work?

Client satisfaction is our top priority, and our process has multiple checkpoints to catch issues early. You see working software every 2 weeks at sprint demos and can provide feedback immediately. If you're unsatisfied with a specific deliverable, we revise it in the next sprint based on your feedback. For fixed-price projects, the UAT phase (2 weeks) exists specifically for you to verify that the work meets acceptance criteria before final payment. If a fundamental misalignment occurs (which is rare given our structured discovery process), we offer a 30-day out clause — you can terminate with 30 days' notice, pay only for work completed, and receive all code and documentation produced to date. Our 40+ active clients and high retention rate reflect our commitment to getting it right.